



Budget Guidelines

Successful proposals will include a detailed and realistic budget with reasonable costs required to complete the project. Please note that you are required to complete the 'Reason' (description) field for each budget line item where funds are requested, including references (where possible) for proposed budget amounts, for example, the unit cost of equipment you will be purchasing, or the daily rate of the location you will be using for lodging. You will be able to enter information about co-funding or other funding sources elsewhere on the application, but the Budget form should only include the amount requested from National Geographic Society. You must enter budget information for your proposed project into the online application form using U.S. Dollars (USD), fitting items as closely as possible into the categories provided.

The National Geographic Society prioritizes funding for costs directly required to complete the proposed project, such as travel, lodging, and food (including for team members), as well as lab or studio-based work (including equipment and supplies). Applicants may also request money to cover safety-related costs, such as COVID-19 tests, personal protective equipment (PPE) for their team, cleaning supplies, medical insurance, travel insurance, medication, etc. Applicants may request money for compensation, institutional overhead, and dependent care, as detailed below. The 'Reason' (description) field must be completed for all budget line items requested.

The National Geographic Society does not provide funding for scholarships, tuition, study abroad programs, school living expenses, or internships.

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Compensation (i.e. payment for your time) - Applicant and team member compensation requests are allowed for non-salaried individuals, freelancers, individuals employed less than full-time, or those required to fundraise for their salaries for specific projects. You must justify your request in detail. Freelance storytelling applicants should keep in mind that our publishing partners will have rights to publish work funded by this grant on a fee-free basis, and so should build their day rate into the budget.

Applicants employed in a nine-month full-time university academic position are considered full-time and are not eligible for compensation. However, any K-12 (or equivalent) teacher on a normal nine- or 10-month teaching contract (meaning they do not teach during the break between school years)—even if they are paid over 12 months—is eligible to receive compensation.

Team members are defined as individuals who are contributing to the project. Team members include the applicant, collaborators, local collaborator(s), assistants and/or consultants.

Institutional Overhead - Applicants may designate up to 15% of the total budget as overhead or indirect costs. Typically, these costs are related to administration of your project and grant funds, and may be used by an institution to cover day-to-day operational fees. For example, in a request of \$20,000 in funding from NGS, you may request up to \$3,000 (15% of \$20,000) for institutional overhead.

Monitoring & Evaluation - Applicants may dedicate budget to monitoring and evaluation activities. These activities may include, but are not limited to, theory of change development, evaluation design and implementation, data collection activities such as survey design and respondent incentives, research fees such as IACUC/IRB certification and permits, and consultant fees for any of the former activities.

Dependent Care Assistance - The National Geographic Society has funds available to assist with dependent care. Dependent care is defined as caregiving for a minor (child) or adult dependent for whom you are responsible. If an applicant requires funds for dependent care, we will allow a line item in the budget under the “Dependent Care” category for caregiving assistance. Please provide details within that section to justify the need for dependent care assistance and explain how this budget was determined (e.g., by hourly rate for a local caregiver, travel for the dependent, etc.). These funds can cover the cost of dependent care at home or on-site when grant recipients are in the field for their project, as situationally appropriate.

Budget Details

Please enter the budget information you are requesting from NGS below, fitting items as closely as possible into the categories provided. Utilize the 'Reason' field to elaborate on each entry, as requested per any specified budget guidelines. Note: Number of budget years is determined by your Project Start Date and Project End Date

Category	Year 1 - Planned Amount	Year 1 - Reason	Year 2 - Planned Amount	Year 2 - Reason
Airfare	\$USD		\$USD	
Applicant/Team Member Compensation	\$USD		\$USD	
Assistant/Consultant Compensation	\$USD		\$USD	
Dependent Care	\$USD		\$USD	
Equipment and Supplies	\$USD		\$USD	
Food	\$USD		\$USD	
Laboratory Costs	\$USD		\$USD	
Laboratory Tests	\$USD		\$USD	
Lodging	\$USD		\$USD	
Measurement and Evaluation	\$USD		\$USD	
Miscellaneous	\$USD		\$USD	
Other Transportation	\$USD		\$USD	
Safety/well-being/inclusion Resources	\$USD		\$USD	
Vehicle Rental and Maintenance	\$USD		\$USD	